



HOW WE CAN STOP IT

**RATHER THAN LEARNING FROM MISTAKES, THE STRATEGY
MUST BE TO ASSESS AND THWART FUTURE THREATS**

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Read this list: Jaipur, May 13, 2008: nine blasts in a marketplace, 63 dead, 200 injured. Uttar Pradesh, November 23, 2007: six serial blasts in Varanasi, Faizabad and Lucknow, 14 killed. Hyderabad, August 26, 2007: twin blasts at Lumbini Gardens, 42 killed. Hyderabad, May 18, 2007: blast at Mecca Masjid, 12 dead, 50 injured. Panipat, February 19, 2007: blasts in two coaches of Samjhauta Express, 66 dead, 13 injured. Malegaon, September 8, 2006: three blasts, one in a mosque, 40 dead, 312 injured. Mumbai, July 11, 2006, serial blasts in six local trains, 209 dead, 714 injured. Varanasi, March 7, 2006: blasts near Sankat Mochan temple, 21 dead, 62 injured. Delhi: October 29, 2005: blasts in two busy markets and inside a bus, 62 dead, 155 injured.

It is a chilling chronicle of the most serious threat that Independent India has had to face. This list of the dead and the injured in major terror strikes across India in the past three years does not include victims of similar attacks in Jammu and Kashmir. What it does show clearly is that terror groups are no more confining their activities to the Valley. They are striking at will across India, creating an ever-widening arc of terror—spanning its national capital, its commercial